Combat rule – Corridors, multiple melee foes and flanking · SRD 5.2.1

In a **corridor**, few creatures can fight side by side. **Allies** give ranged attackers **half cover**, and squeezing through a too-narrow space imposes penalties. **Flanking** isn't in the SRD: it's a **table rule** (below).

🎲 Quick summary:

1. **5 ft** corridor: one front.
2. A creature between you and the target: **half cover** (+2 AC).
3. Too-narrow space: **Disadvantage** on attacks and Dex checks.
4. Flanking: **Table rule**, Advantage.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 clarifies that creatures, friend or foe, grant cover. Flanking stays optional.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

The SRD doesn't limit how many attackers surround a target. Fix: 8 melee attackers maximum (5 ft squares), fewer if terrain interferes.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the corridor as a cork: shoulders rubbing, torches swaying.

Step 1 – Measure:

Passage width: 5 ft = one front; 10 ft = two abreast.

Step 2 – Place:

Who's in front? Reach weapons (10 ft) let a second rank strike.

Step 3 – Shoot:

An archer behind an ally gives the target **half cover**: +2 AC and Dex.

Step 4 – Squeeze:

Moving into a smaller space costs extra movement and gives **Disadvantage** on attacks.

Step 5 – Flank:

Table rule: an ally on the opposite side of the target gives you **Advantage**.

Example: Yan holds a 5-ft corridor. Two goblins can only attack him one at a time; behind him, the archer shoots with half cover.

Width	Fighters abreast	Note
5 ft	1	Reach 10 ft: a second rank
10 ft	2	An archer behind each front
15 ft	3	Flanking possible
20 ft or more	4 or more	Open fight

⚠ Common questions:

How many foes around a target?
Up to 8 in melee.

Does a creature grant cover?
Yes, half cover.

What rule for squeezing?
Extra movement and Disadvantage.

Is flanking in the SRD?
No, it's optional.

Does reach help?
Yes, it lets you strike over an ally.

Can I pass through an ally?
Yes, but not stop in its space.

⚠ Debate points and table options: Table rule

Flanking
Advantage if an ally is opposite. **Option**: +2 to attack only.

Multiple sources
Do advantages stack? **Option**: never twice.

Melee vs several
Can I disengage for free? **Option**: no, normal Opportunity Attack.

Blocked corridor
Can a body block the passage? **Option**: yes.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Half cover
+2 to AC and Dexterity saves.

Reach
10 ft for reach weapons.

Flanking
Table rule, not in the SRD.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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